

NEW ENGLAND CRUST

Ninja Woodfire Quick-Start Guide

The four accessories to buy first. Two pellet bags worth keeping stocked.
Stone temperatures that actually work. Everything we learned so you don't have to.



· OO101 OWNER'S COMPANION ·

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SECTION ONE

Buy These Before You Fire It Up

The Ninja Woodfire ships with more than most people expect — a 12-inch pizza stone, Pro-Heat pan, roast rack, pellet scoop, and a starter pellet bag. You can cook on day one. What's missing are the four things almost every owner needs within the first two weeks.

1. A Quality Cover

~\$25 — buy before the first cook

Ninja XSKOCVR (official) or a third-party OO100-series cover

The Woodfire is weather-resistant, not weatherproof. A New England winter will find the weak spots. The official cover fits perfectly. A well-reviewed third-party cover runs about half the price and holds up fine through rain and wind.

2. A 12-Gauge Outdoor Extension Cord

~\$20 — non-negotiable

At least 15 ft. Look for 'outdoor rated' and 12 AWG on the label

The oven's cord is 4.5 feet. Unless your outlet is exactly where you want to cook, you need an extension. The 12-gauge rating matters — the oven draws real wattage and a thin indoor cord can overheat. Don't grab whatever's in the garage.

3. A Perforated Pizza Peel

~\$20 — buy before pizza night #2

Ninja XSKOPPL (fits the OO101 opening perfectly) or a 12-inch aluminum peel

You can slide the first pizza onto a cold stone without one. The second pizza — onto a 700°F stone — is essentially impossible without a peel. The perforations let excess flour fall away instead of burning on the stone.

4. An Infrared Thermometer

~\$18 — the single best upgrade for pizza quality

Any food-safe model works — Etekcity is reliable and under \$20

The oven display shows air temperature. Stone surface temperature can run 100°F lower or higher. Stone temp is what determines crust. Point the thermometer at the stone — when it reads 650–750°F you're ready. Before we owned one, about 1 in 4 pizzas underwhelmed. After: every pizza, every time.

SECTION TWO

Pellets: What to Keep Stocked

The hopper holds roughly half a cup and lasts about an hour of active smoke. Pellets are for flavor, not fuel — the oven runs on electricity. You don't need them every cook, only when you want that wood-fired character.

PELLET BAG	BEST FOR	NOTES
Ninja All-Purpose Blend (cherry / maple / oak)	Pizza, chicken, vegetables, fish	Start here. Works on everything. Mild, slightly sweet.
Ninja Robust Blend (hickory / cherry / maple / oak)	Pulled pork, ribs, brisket, beef	Classic BBQ smoke. Strong but not overpowering.
Kona Variety Pack (8 × 1 lb bags)	Experimenting with wood flavor profiles	Not official Ninja brand but works perfectly. Good way to find your favorites.
Mesquite — wait on this	Red meat only	Polarizing flavor. Try a small bag before committing.

STORAGE TIP

Keep pellets in an airtight container away from moisture. Damp pellets smoke poorly and can clog the hopper.

SECTION THREE

Stone Temperatures That Actually Work

The display reads air temperature. Stone surface runs different — often 100°F lower during preheat, occasionally higher during a long cook. Use an infrared thermometer pointed at the stone, not the display, to know when you're actually ready.

COOK	TARGET STONE TEMP	PREHEAT TIME	NOTES
Neapolitan-style pizza	700–750°F	20–25 min	Cooks in 90–120 sec. Watch it — goes fast.
NY-style / thicker crust	575–625°F	18–22 min	More forgiving. Good for first-timers.
Chicken thighs / drumsticks	375–425°F	12–15 min	Use roast rack. Internal temp 165°F.
Smoked pork shoulder	225–250°F	10 min	Low & slow. Refill pellets every 45–60 min.
Roasted vegetables	450–500°F	15 min	Use Pro-Heat pan. High heat = good char.

SECTION FOUR

What Comes in the Box (So You Don't Rebuy It)

A lot of new owners spend money on things the OO101 already includes. Before you buy anything, confirm you already have these.

✓ **Ninja Woodfire Oven (OO101)**

The oven itself, obviously — but worth noting the model number for accessory compatibility.

✓ **12-inch Square Pizza Stone**

Fits the OO101 perfectly. Don't buy a replacement stone until this one cracks, which may never happen.

✓ **Pro-Heat Pan**

Multi-use — roasting, searing, baking. Handles most tasks you'd otherwise buy a cast iron tray for.

✓ **Roast Rack**

Elevates chicken, pork, and other meats over the Pro-Heat pan for even airflow.

✓ **Accessory Frame**

The internal frame that holds the pizza stone or Pro-Heat pan at the correct height.

✓ **Pellet Scoop**

A fine scoop. No reason to buy a second one — Ninja sells extras for \$7-8 each. Skip it.

✓ **All-Purpose Blend Starter Pack**

One small bag. Enough for 2-3 cooks. Plan to restock.

The oven will surprise you. The crust will come faster than you expect, the smoke is subtler than you think, and by the third pizza night you'll have a system. We're at newenglandcrust.com whenever you need it.